



Mahmoud Adel

Application Security & Offensive Security Engineer | B.Sc. Software Engineering

Application Security · Offensive Security Engineering · B.Sc. Software Engineering
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Email

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HTB

THM

Based in Egypt (UTC+2) · Open to Remote & Global Relocation
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PROFILE

Cybersecurity Engineer driven by a deep fascination with low-level systems and system architecture. Inspired to enter the field early on, I developed a passion for understanding the "core mechanics" of technology—earning the moniker Kernel. From offensive mechanics to SOC defense, I view infrastructure security as an art form built on fundamental system principles.

20+
HOF

Top 0.55%
HACKTHEBOX

EXPERIENCE

Security Engineering Intern July 10 – September 10, 2024

Bastion Security — Security Engineering Internship

- Completed Penetration Testing & Application Security internship track — company-led lectures, CTF challenges, vulnerability-exploitation lab work.
- Conducted a research project analyzing web application cache-attack techniques.
- Ranked **Top 5 of 100** in internal penetration-testing and privilege-escalation challenges.

[View Credential](#) → · Bastion Security internship certificate

Software Engineer Intern Feb 2025 – June 2026

National Research Tomsk State University

- Delivered **2 MVPs + 12 diagrams** (UML/SDLC) — builds system reasoning for reproducible findings.

SECURITY RECOGNITION & EVIDENCE

Hall of Fame — 20+ acknowledgments via Bugcrowd (bugcrowd.com/h/mahmoud_adel) — Named: Verisign \$1,000 CSRF → Account Takeover (DomainScope OAuth state, Apr 2018), DigitalOcean (Apr 2019), Pinterest & Dell (2018). **CRITICAL**

Competitive & labs: Bastion internal CTF **Top 5/100**; Hack The Box **Top 0.55% Pro Hacker** — [verified badges](#); TryHackMe **Top 1%** — [@iamkernel](#). **VERIFIED**

Detection & research: ELK SOC Home Lab — 50k+ events, 5 Sigma MITRE-mapped, Kibana dashboards & triage workflow; IR malware triage (isolated Windows 10 VM, Sysmon/KAPE); AppArmor RCE mitigation; API security & AD attack paths. **LAB**

SECURITY RESEARCH

- Verisign CSRF → Account Takeover** — Missing OAuth state → Google-link hijack → persistent ATO + password set (\$1,000 reward, HoF Apr 2018). [Write-up ↗](#)
- AppArmor RCE Killswitch** — Deny /bin/** + network → audit DENIED exec /bin/sh → allowlist containment + hardening. [Write-up ↗](#)
- ELK SOC Detection Engineering** — 50k+ events, 5 Sigma MITRE-mapped rules, Kibana dashboards & triage workflow. [Write-up ↗](#)

CORE SKILLS

CORE

Web/API Security

Vulnerability Assessment

Linux

Windows

TCP/IP

Privilege Escalation (lab)

Burp Suite

Nmap

Python

Bash

APPLIED

OWASP

Network Security

Active Directory

Kerberos

Wireshark

BloodHound

Impacket

Docker

System Administration

Firewall

SIEM (ELK)

Incident Response

MITRE ATT&CK

Cloud Security (AWS IAM)

FAMILIAR

Ghidra (lab)

Metasploit (lab)

Cobalt Strike (exposure)

Sliver (lab)

Nuclei (lab)

SQLMap (lab)

ffuf (lab)

Malware Analysis (lab)

Threat Intel (exposure)

Exploit Dev (lab)

Red Team (lab)

YARA (lab)

Sigma (lab)

Suricata (lab)

Splunk (lab)

ENGINEERING

JavaScript

C/C++

Assembly

SQL

Git

Presentation

Problem Solving

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Software Engineering — Conferred Jul 2026
Tomsk State University
Sep 2022 – Jul 2026

CREDENTIALS & TRAINING

Blue Team Junior Analyst
SecurityBlue Team · 2023
[Verify ↗](#)

Cyber Threat Intelligence
IBM · 2023
[Verify badge ↗](#)

Jr Penetration Tester
TryHackMe · 2024
[Verify PDF ↗](#)

PRACTICAL LABS & PLATFORMS

[Hack The Box — Verified Badges · Top 0.55% Pro Hacker](#)
[TryHackMe — @iamkernel · Top 1%](#)

LANGUAGES

Arabic · Native
English · C2 Proficient
Russian · C1 Advanced